User Personas

The two people our first release (the closed beta) is built for. Each persona is a composite drawn from our research; the names and quotes are illustrative, not real people.

M Maya, the overwhelmed restarter

Audience 1 · 26 · works full time · ADHD diagnosed as an adult

"I've started a budget five times. One busy week and I'm too embarrassed to open the app again."

Has tried two budgeting apps and a spreadsheet, and quit each within a few weeks. Not bad at math; long setups and catch-up work drain the motivation before any payoff.

GOALS

- Feel in control of money without it becoming a big project
- Break the start-then-quit cycle
- Less anxiety and self-blame about money

FRUSTRATIONS

- Setup takes too long and asks too many questions
- Missing a week means hours of catching up
- Red numbers and broken streaks feel like failing

KEY MOMENTS

- **First download:** needs to finish setup in about 3 minutes
- **After a missed week:** back on track in under a minute
- **Payday:** see what's left after bills at a glance

WHAT HELPS

- Quick setup that saves its place
- One-tap fresh start, with no mention of time away
- Calm screens, kind words, no streaks

Job to be done: When I've fallen off my budget, I want to restart in one tap, so I can get back on track without guilt.

J Jordan, the surprise-hit spender

Audience 2 · 31 · irregular hours · self-identifies as having ADHD

"I'm never broke on purpose. A bill I forgot or a late-night order sneaks up on me, and then the fees hit."

Earns enough to cover the bills but keeps getting caught out by due dates, free trials that renew and impulse buys. Checks the bank balance, which hides money already owed to bills.

GOALS

- Stop losing money to fees and forgotten subscriptions
- Spend on fun things without guilt, knowing it's safe
- Fewer money surprises and less stress

FRUSTRATIONS

- Bills are remembered only after the late fee
- Apps flag impulse buys after the money is gone
- Dashboards of charts are too much to read

KEY MOMENTS

- **About to buy something big:** is it safe to spend?
- **Days before a bill:** a heads-up with time to act
- **Free trial ending:** catch it before it renews

WHAT HELPS

- Safe-to-spend number first on the home screen
- 7-day bill countdown and snoozable reminders
- An optional pause and 24-hour wishlist for big buys

Job to be done: When I'm about to spend, I want to see what's safe after my bills, so I can enjoy it without a surprise later.

Research behind both personas: about 1 in 14 adults has ADHD (Design Monks, 2026); adults with ADHD symptoms save less and more often avoid or rush money decisions (Bangma et al., PLOS ONE, 2020); long flows, busy screens and shame push users away, while short steps, autosave and calm design help (Accessibility Checker, 2026; UXPA, 2025; Din Studio, 2025; iFactory, 2025).

Next: check both personas against interviews with 8 adults with ADHD in research week 1, recruiting a balanced gender mix (Spiel et al., CHI 2022). A third persona, couples where one partner has ADHD, joins at the public launch.

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